

FAB4 Does Europe

Audit - Connections, Transfers & Travel Documents - September 2026

This document lists every flight, ship, hire-car and transfer connection across the whole trip (10-29 September 2026), in order, with its current booking status (Sections 1-7). Section 8 cross-checks the website against the official Infinity Holidays / Envoyage Travel Documents, most recently updated 21 Aug 2026 with confirmed transfers and tour details added, and lists every variation found. Anywhere a connection or detail needs action is called out clearly - see the summary on the last page.

1. Outbound - Wellington to Rome (10-11 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Thu 10 Sep	WLG → SYD	QF162 (Qantas), 6:05am→7:45am, Business - Gary & Karen only (Debbie & Tom join the group in Sydney)	Booked
Thu 10 Sep	Sydney connection	Arrive T1 7:45am → depart T1 2:45pm (~7 hr layover, same terminal, no hotel/day-room booked)	Long layover - confirm plan
Thu 10 Sep	SYD → SIN	QF1 (Qantas), 2:45pm→9:15pm, Premium Economy, all 4	Booked
Thu 10 Sep	Singapore connection	Arrive T1 9:15pm → depart T1 11:20/11:25pm (~2 hr, Qantas → British Airways, both oneworld)	Confirm bags check through to FCO
Thu 10-Fri 11 Sep	SIN → LHR	BA12 (British Airways), 11:20/11:25pm→6:35am +1, Premium Economy, all 4	Booked
Fri 11 Sep	Heathrow connection	Arrive T5 6:35am → depart T5 8:00am - ~1 hr 25 min (85 min), same terminal. BA's minimum connection time at Heathrow T5 is 75 minutes (raised from 60 min in Jan 2024), so this clears the minimum but only by about 10 minutes.	TIGHT - meets BA minimum (just)
Fri 11 Sep	LHR → FCO	BA548 (British Airways), 8:00am→11:35am, Business (Gary & Karen) / Economy (Debbie & Tom)	Booked
Fri 11 Sep	FCO → The Republic Hotel	Private minibus, Fiumicino Airport to Via Gaeta 61, Rome (~30-45 min)	No confirmation/booking reference on file - confirm with Lynaire

2. Rome to the Cunard cruise (11-14 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Mon 14 Sep	The Republic Hotel → Civitavecchia	Private minibus to Queen Victoria cruise terminal - 12pm pickup, evening departure (confirmed via the updated Travel Documents, itinerary note dated 21 Aug 2026)	Booked - 12pm pickup confirmed

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Mon 14 Sep	Board Queen Victoria	Cunard voyage V618D – Deck 8 (Balcony), cabins 8118 (Gary & Karen) and 8112 (Debbie & Tom); booking no. CNZ-83509 – corrected from 4025/4031 (Deck 4) in the previous version of this audit, per the Deck 8 plan confirmed this update	Booked
16-19 Sep	Shore excursions	Marseille, Villefranche, Genoa, La Spezia (Pisa) – all booked via Cunard Shore Excursions	Booked

3. Cruise, hire car and the overland leg (14-24 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Mon 21 Sep	Civitavecchia → collect hire car	Avis Mercedes Vito (manual transmission), booking ref NZ759149602, at the cruise terminal – vehicle changed from the automatic Ford Kuga SUV in the original 14 Jan quote; confirm whoever drives is comfortable with a manual gearbox	Booked - note transmission change
21-24 Sep	Self-drive: Civitavecchia → Talamone → Tuscany → Milan	Own hire car for the whole overland leg – no separate transfer booking needed	In hand (self-drive)
Thu 24 Sep	Milan → return hire car	Return Mercedes Vito at Milan Linate Airport before the flight (4-day hire, Mon 21–Thu 24, confirmed in the 19 Aug Travel Documents – corrected from Wed 23 Sep in the previous version of this audit)	Booked

4. Milan to London (24 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Thu 24 Sep	LIN → LHR	BA575 (British Airways), 3:55pm→4:50pm, Business, all 4 – site corrected from an earlier 2:30pm/2:50pm error (see Section 8)	Booked
Thu 24 Sep	Heathrow (T5) → The Level, Meliá White House	Site now shows the reconciled version: Luxury Private Vehicle transfer via The Traveling Group / London Travel In (office +44 (0)20 8049 4300, emergency +44 7733 448902), plus booking ref 190826 appended. Re-timed to ~5:15pm pickup given the corrected 4:50pm landing.	Booked - reconciled with official document
Thu 24 Sep	Tight evening connection	With the corrected flight/transfer timing, hotel arrival is now ~6:00pm, only ~30 min before the 6:30pm Lighterman dinner booking – "Tapas & Gin for Deb" likely won't fit	Decide: skip pre-dinner drinks or move dinner booking

5. London departure (27 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Sun 27 Sep	Meliá White House → Heathrow (T5)	Leave hotel 7:00pm for 10:00pm BA15 departure – no transfer mode confirmed	NOT CONFIRMED - confirm transfer to airport

6. Return - London to Wellington (27-29 Sept)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Sun 27-Mon 28 Sep	LHR → SIN	BA15 (British Airways), 10:00pm→6:40pm +1, Premium Economy, all 4	Booked
Mon 28 Sep	Singapore turnaround	Arrive T1 6:40pm → depart T1 8:20pm (~1 hr 40 min) – same flight number (BA15) continuing to Sydney	Confirm re-boarding process at Changi
Mon 28-Tue 29 Sep	SIN → SYD	BA15 (British Airways), 8:20pm→6:05am +1, Premium Economy, all 4	Booked
Tue 29 Sep	Sydney - trip ends for Debbie & Tom	Arrive T1 6:05am – Sydney is home, no further connection needed	N/A
Tue 29 Sep	Sydney connection (Gary & Karen only)	Arrive T1 6:05am → depart T1 9:35am (~3 hr 30 min, same terminal)	Booked
Tue 29 Sep	SYD → WLG	QF161 (Qantas), 9:35am→3:45pm, Economy, Gary & Karen only	Booked

7. Travel documents (ETA, passport, IDP)

Date	Connection	Details	Status
Ongoing	UK Electronic Travel Authorisation	Required for all 4 NZ passport holders, £16 each, enforced from 25 Feb 2026	Verify all 4 applied/approved via site checklist
Ongoing	Passport validity	Needs 6+ months' validity remaining at end of trip (29 Sep 2026) – valid to at least 29 Mar 2027	Verify all 4 checked via site checklist
Ongoing	International Driving Permit (IDP)	Whoever drives in Italy needs a valid IDP alongside their licence – Gary's is confirmed (IDP196978); Karen, Debbie and Tom not yet ticked	Verify remaining 3 via site checklist

8. Website vs official Travel Documents (updated 21 Aug 2026) - variations found

Cross-checked against "Travel Documents for Nicholson-Gyde and Akhurst" (Infinity Holidays / Envoyage, Booking ID 8381895, issued 19 Aug 2026, updated with transfers and tours added 21 Aug 2026), plus the individual Vatican Museums and Colosseum tour vouchers.

Item	Site currently shows	Official document shows	Status
BA575 Milan→London flight time	FIXED: day-24 schedule event, the day-route map note, and the London Things-to-Do note now all say the flight departs 3:55pm, arrives 4:50pm	Official Travel Documents (19 Aug) and the Flight Summary/Connections Audit: BA575 departs 3:55pm, arrives 4:50pm, Business, all 4	Corrected - now matches
Heathrow → hotel transfer supplier	FIXED: site now shows the Luxury Private Vehicle transfer via The Traveling Group / London Travel In, with booking ref 190826 appended, re-timed to ~5:15pm pickup	Official Travel Documents show a "Luxury Private Vehicle" transfer via The Traveling Group / London Travel In - office +44 (0)20 8049 4300, emergency +44 7733 448902 - no ref number given in the document itself	Reconciled - official supplier + ref kept together
Hire car return date	Site (and this document, now corrected) show the Avis Mercedes Vito returned Thu 24 Sep at Milan Linate	Official Travel Documents confirm a 4-day hire, Mon 21 - Thu 24 Sep	Matches after correction in this update
Traveller name - Deb Gyde	FIXED: site now uses "Deb Gyde" consistently everywhere (checklists, flight-summary legend, Emergency Contacts, front-cover credit line)	Official Travel Documents use "Deborah Gyde" (her booking/passport name) - "Deb" is Gary's preferred everyday short form	Standardised site-wide - booking name unaffected
Travel advisor name spelling	FIXED: site's Things to Do note now spells the name "Lynaire" (one N)	Official Travel Documents and her email confirm "Lynaire Monnery" (one N), lynaire.monnery@envoyage.co.nz	Corrected - now matches
Avis Mercedes Vito booking reference	Site shows booking ref NZ759149602	Official Travel Documents confirm the same reference, NZ759149602	Confirmed match
The Republic Hotel (Rome) details	Address, phone (+39 06 8115 7001) and dates (11-14 Sept) shown in Hotel Directory	Official Travel Documents confirm same address/phone/dates, plus booking refs 5179180 (Gary & Karen) and 5179179 (Debbie & Tom)	FIXED - booking refs 5179180 / 5179179 now shown in Hotel Directory
Hotel Borgo di Cortefreda Relais details	Address, phone (+39 055 807 3333) and dates (21-23 Sept) shown in Hotel Directory	Official Travel Documents confirm same address/phone/dates, plus booking refs 900422765/900422785 and hotel confirmation numbers 45873846/45873847	FIXED - booking refs 900422765 / 900422785 (confs. 45873846/45873847) now shown in Hotel Directory

Item	Site currently shows	Official document shows	Status
iQ Hotel Milano details	Address, phone (+39 02 8498 0810) and dates (23-24 Sept) shown in Hotel Directory	Official Travel Documents list two different phone numbers internally (+39 02 4550461 in the header block vs 39-02-84980810 in the booking remarks) – site matches the booking-remarks number. Booking refs 9079750869671/9074737872483, confirmations 2385198897/2385198904	FIXED - booking refs 9079750869671 / 9074737872483 (confs. 2385198897/2385198904) now shown in Hotel Directory
The Level at Meliá White House details	Address, phone (+44 20 7391 3000) and dates (24-27 Sept) shown in Hotel Directory	Official Travel Documents confirm same address/phone/dates, plus booking refs 702Lb92xxk (Gary & Karen) and 702Hpxuze6 (Debbie & Tom)	FIXED - booking refs 702Lb92xxk / 702Hpxuze6 now shown in Hotel Directory
Traveller list (4 adults)	Site groups Karen & Gary Nicholson, and Deborah Gyde & Thomas Akhurst throughout	Official Travel Documents confirm the same 4 travellers and pairing	Confirmed match
Fiumicino → Republic Hotel transfer	Site and previous version of this audit both say "arranged in principle, no booking reference on file"	Not in the confirmed 23-page itinerary at all. The original 14 Jan quote did include it (Private Minibus via Destination Italia, indicative cancellation charge \$246.14) – see the separate Itinerary Comparison document	Still needs to be booked/confirmed - no change
Rome hotel → Civitavecchia transfer	FIXED: site now shows a 12pm pickup, status Booked (see Section 2)	Updated Travel Documents (itinerary note dated 21 Aug 2026) confirm "*** 12PM pick up ***" for the private minibus transfer	Corrected - now matches
Vatican tour (Sat 12 Sep) & Colosseum tour (Sun 13 Sep)	FIXED: site now shows the Vatican Museums & Sistine Chapel Tour (Towns of Italy, Booking Ref 5CJM745M, 7:45am start) and the Colosseum, Roman Forum & Palatine Hill Tour (Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831, 2:30pm start), each with its own confirmation voucher and QR code on the day card	Individual tour vouchers uploaded separately confirm: Vatican – Towns of Italy, Ref 5CJM745M, 07:45am, meeting point Viale Vaticano; Colosseum – Gray Line Rome, Booking ID 202645831, 2:30pm, meeting point Colle Oppio Park. Previous "Pristine Sistine"/"Arena Floor & VIP Caesar's Palace" (Walks of Italy) listings were incorrect and have been replaced	Corrected - real bookings now shown, with voucher QR codes
Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour combo (Sat 26 Sep)	Trip at a Glance still shows Sat 26 Sep as UNCONFIRMED; Things to Do lists it as "To be confirmed by Jennifer from Headout"	Checked the garrison.co.nz mailbox for a reply from jennifer@inspire.headout.com – no booking confirmation found, only an earlier guidance thread on how to book. Six the Musical (same day, 4:00pm) is booked separately and confirmed – Headout booking #32832547	Still needs to be confirmed - no change
Travel Documents file	Site's Travel Docs button/QR now link to the updated document ("Transfers and Tours Added"), issued 21 Aug 2026 – supersedes the 19 Aug version	Updated Travel Documents (21 Aug 2026) add confirmed transfer times and the Vatican/Colosseum tour details cross-checked above	Replaced - now current

Item	Site currently shows	Official document shows	Status
After-hours Emergency Assist number	Not shown anywhere on the website	Official Travel Documents list an After-hours Emergency Assist line: 0800 232 666 (NZ) / +1 201 746 5104 (overseas)	Missing from site - add to Emergency Contacts

Summary: items that still need action

These are flagged in red above – a booking, confirmation or correction is needed:

- Meliá White House → Heathrow transfer (Sun 27 Sep): no transfer mode confirmed for the 7:00pm hotel departure.
- Fiumicino → Republic Hotel transfer (Fri 11 Sep): arranged in principle but no booking reference is on file, and it doesn't appear in the confirmed 23-page itinerary at all – only in the original 14 Jan quote.
- Tower of London + Crown Jewels + River Tour combo (Sat 26 Sep): still not confirmed – checked the garrison.co.nz mailbox for a reply from Jennifer at Headout, found only a guidance thread, no booking confirmation.
- After-hours Emergency Assist number: 0800 232 666 (NZ) / +1 201 746 5104 (overseas), given in the official Travel Documents but missing from the website – add to Emergency Contacts.

Worth a closer look (flagged in amber above) – nothing critical, but tight or worth double-checking:

- Sydney layover on the way out (Thu 10 Sep, ~7 hrs): RESEARCHED – you can leave the airport. NZ passport holders get a Special Category (subclass 444) visa automatically on arrival, and 7 hrs comfortably clears the ~5 hr minimum needed to get into the city and back (allow ~45 min immigration, ~60 min security).
- Singapore connection on the way out (Thu 10 Sep, ~2 hrs): changes airline from Qantas to British Airways – confirm baggage is checked through to Rome.
- Heathrow connection on the way out (Fri 11 Sep, ~1 hr 25 min / 85 min): a tight turnaround after a 13+ hour flight. BA's minimum connection time at T5 is 75 minutes, so this clears it – but only by about 10 minutes, with no margin for a late arrival.
- Singapore turnaround on the way home (Mon 28 Sep, ~1 hr 40 min, BA15): RESEARCHED – everyone must deplane at Changi with carry-on items (no staying onboard), and must re-clear security before the Sydney sector (security is at the gate). No passport control needed on a through-checked single ticket. Queues can be long as the whole aircraft transits together.
- Thu 24 Sep evening (Milan→London day): with the corrected BA575/transfer timing, hotel arrival is now ~6:00pm – only ~30 min before the 6:30pm Lighterman booking. "Tapas & Gin for Deb" likely won't fit; decide whether to skip it or move the dinner booking.
- UK ETA, passport validity and IDP: all have checklists on the website, but this document can't see whether every box is ticked – worth a final look before departure.
- Hire car is a manual Mercedes Vito (changed from the automatic Ford Kuga SUV in the original quote) – confirm whoever's driving in Italy is comfortable with a manual gearbox.

Everything else - all flights, the cruise booking, the hire car, the Sydney/Wellington domestic connections, and every hotel's address/phone/dates - is booked and confirmed, and matches the official Travel Documents (see Flight Summary, Hotel Directory and Travel Documents on the website for the full reference numbers).